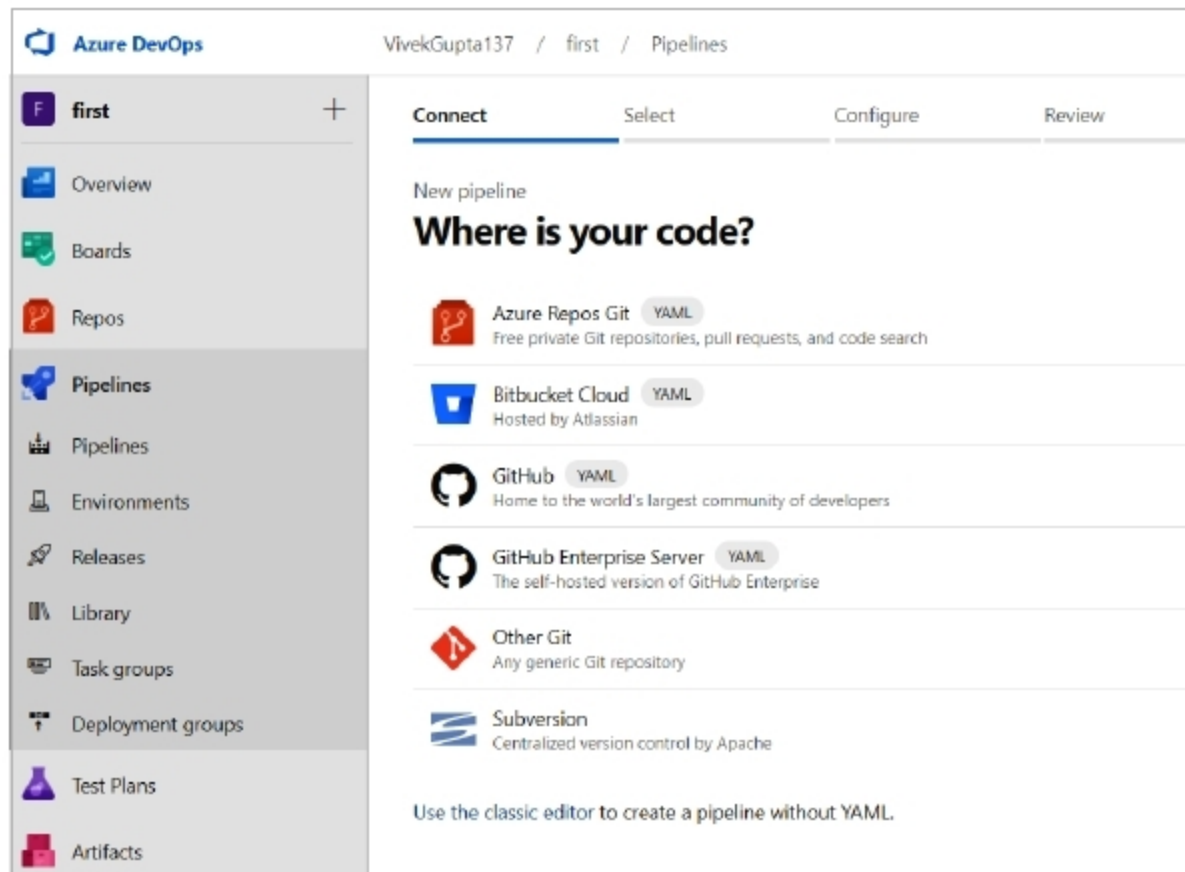


Figure 4: Screen after clicking the *Create pipeline* button

source repository. The contents of secure files are encrypted and can only be used during the build or release pipeline by referencing them from a task.

2. **Task groups:** These enable the reuse of parts with similar functionality, as well as grouping and reusing them in multiple pipelines.
3. **Deployment groups:** These are groups of environments, which developers wish to release. For example: Dev, Prod, QA, and test.

The logs are the result of running the pipeline. They contain the outputs of the steps described in the pipeline.

Test plans: Manual or automated tests are stored here. These can be functionality tests like unit tests, or smoke tests, or load and performance tests. The results can be stored and integrated into the process, and insights obtained on the functional coverage. Using Azure test plans, one can track which particular part of the software was tested and by whom.

Exploratory test sessions can also be run against specific deployments.

Artifacts: Azure DevOps makes it easy to store and manage all the artifacts that the software generates. This is where various NuGet (a free and open source package manager designed for the Microsoft development platform) and Node packages can be published. It serves as an artifact repository.

This is helpful in situations where:

1. You need to know if a specific package is being used.
2. You need to block an infected package and fall back to a previous or newer version.

Packages that have been pulled from outside and have become part of the software can be traced.

Creating a simple pipeline

To demonstrate the use of the Azure pipeline, we'll build a simple website that can be run locally, in a container, or in the cloud.

The website is a simple HTML page, along with an Nginx Alpine-based Docker image that will serve this page and run inside a Docker container. The next step is to push this container into the Azure container registry.

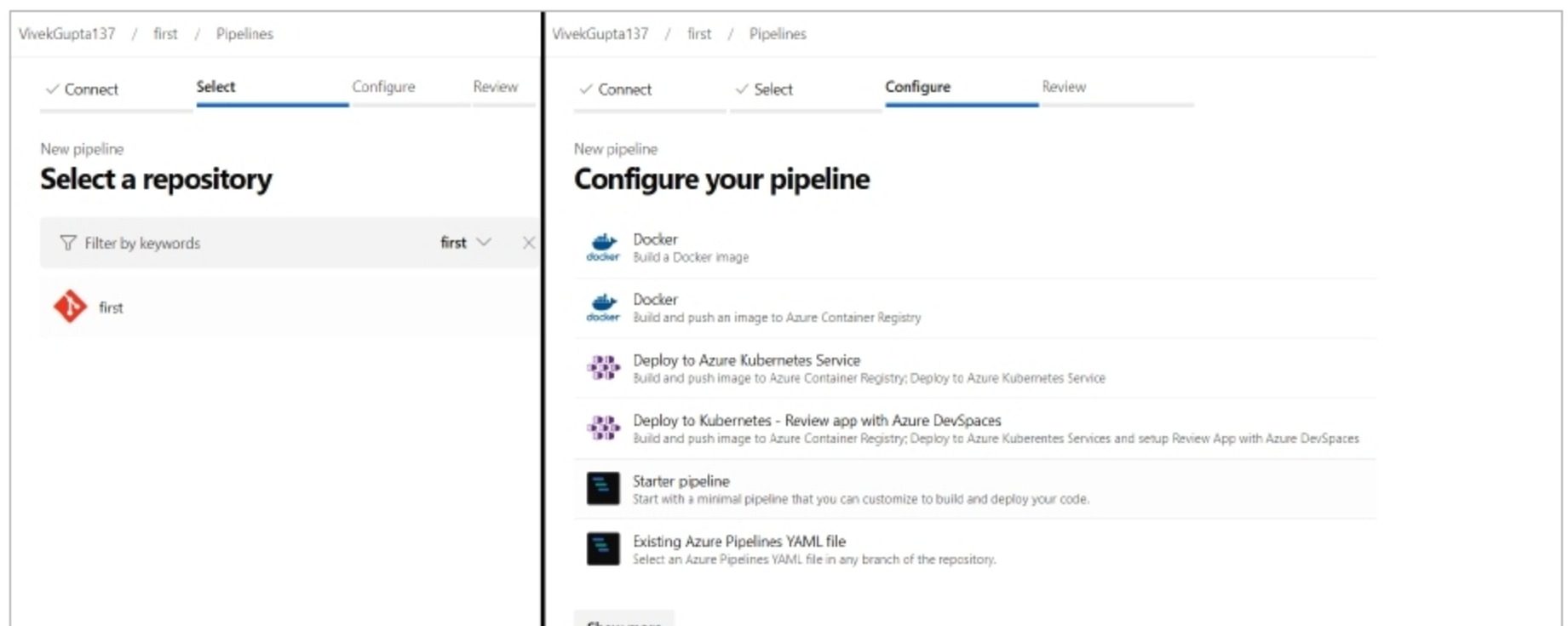


Figure 5: Configuring the pipeline